Morocco *Wedding Photographers Retreat*

A retreat for wedding photographers in Marrakech and the Agafay Desert

MARCH 26 TO 31, 2027 | MARRAKECH, MOROCCO

Sarah Lord Photo x Habitat

Sarah Lord | hello@sarahlordphoto.com Habitat | habitat@habitatretreats.com

Carrigan (Habitat) | 903-515-0061

Flight + Info Form
Flights, dietary needs, health notes, emergency contact

Roommate Matching Quiz
Coming on your own? Start here

Questions
habitat@habitatretreats.com

Download PDF
Save the guide for travel day and offline

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01

You're in for the Morocco Retreat! We can't wait to sip Aperol Spritz at sunset with you.

This guide has everything you need for the Morocco Wedding Photographers Retreat, in one place. Inside you'll find:

- Flight info: which airports to fly into, what times work, transfers
- What's included and what isn't
- The itinerary for the week
- Frequently Asked Questions
- And a few extras!

We highly recommend reading it through once, then coming back to it as needed.

This week is really built for us to have fun and explore a new place together! Absolutely everything is optional, we just want to connect and let loose for a fun vacation.

If something isn't clear or you have additional questions, please reach out!

We can't wait to experience the magic of Morocco with you!

Xx,
Sarah Lord + Habitat

YOUR RETREAT AT A GLANCE

RETREAT	Morocco Wedding Photographers Retreat
DATES	Friday, March 26 to Wednesday, March 31, 2027 (5 nights)
WHERE	Riad BE Marrakech (3 nights) + BE Agafay desert camp (2 nights), Morocco

ARRIVE	Marrakesh Menara Airport (RAK) on Friday, March 26. Land whenever works for you. Our first group get-together is at 5pm
DEPART	Check out of camp by 11:30am on Wednesday, March 31. Book the latest flight possible. It's about 45 minutes from the desert to the airport
HOSTS	Sarah Lord (Sarah Lord Photo) + Carrigan Whiteley (Habitat)
THE WEEK	Medina souks, a sunrise hot air balloon, the YSL gardens, quad bikes and pottery in the desert. Everything optional
YOUR ROOM	Shared, see Where You'll Stay
QUESTIONS	Email **habitat@habitatretreats.com**. Habitat handles all logistics

02

Housekeeping

- **This is a retreat, not a workshop.** There are no styled shoots, content days, etc. Obviously bring your camera if you want it! But no one is forcing you to if you don't want to. Also, everything is optional. If you would rather skip the Hot Air Balloon ride and spend the afternoon by the pool, go for it!
- **Leave the drone at home.** Drones are banned in Morocco. Customs confiscates them at the airport and you won't get it back. Cameras are completely fine.
- **The medina is a maze.** Cars can't get into most of the old city, so the last stretch to the riad is on foot, with a porter and a cart for your bags. Pack a bag you can live with being wheeled down dirt or cobbled streets.
- **Marrakech is a lot, in the best way.** Motorbikes in the alleys, shopkeepers calling you in, the call to prayer five times a day. It's loud and it's alive. Then you walk through the riad door and it's quiet. Day 4, the desert is the reset.
- **Dress code.** Morocco is a Muslim country and we want to respect local customs. Please bring an outfit that covers your knees and shoulders, especially for the market day. This can be a shawl you throw on or a long skirt. We just ask that you be prepared and respectful.
- **Late March is warm by day, cold at night.** Around 22°C / 72°F in the afternoon. The desert drops much colder after sunset. Bring layers.
- **Wi-Fi.** Yes, there is wifi available both at the Riad and at the Desert Camp.
- **You're sharing space with people you may not know.** Most people arrive solo, some come with friends. If something is bothering you, tell us early (see the **Anonymous Feedback Form** in section 10). We can fix things in real time. Don't wait until the week is over to put it out there. That's a disservice to you and to the people around you.
- **Plans can change.** Weather will determine our Hot Air Balloon ride, which may require us to rearrange the itinerary. We try our best to stick to the plan, but occasionally we have to adapt. We will always communicate if that needs to happen, and just ask that you remain flexible with the situation while we sort through it.

03

Day-by-day itinerary

Here's our overview of the week. Exact times and meeting points will live in a live link given on the retreat, so that if changes need to be made, you always refer to the same place to find them. We will also communicate everything via the group message.

Day 1

FRI, MARCH 26

Touch down in Marrakech

- Land at Marrakesh Menara Airport (RAK). We will have a car to pick you up at the airport.
- Check in and settle into our home for the next three nights, a colorful traditional riad in the heart of the medina.
- 5pm | Meet us on the roof for sunset welcome drinks + dinner

Meals: Dinner | **Wear:** Something comfy, plus a layer for the rooftop if it gets chilly after dark

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Day 2

SAT, MARCH 27

Souk day

- Breakfast on the rooftop
- Into the souk together
- Lunch out in the market
- Free afternoon: more souk time, the pool, or a hammam at the riad (optional, on your own tab)
- Dinner out together

Easily some of the best shopping you'll do anywhere. Leather bags, hand-loomed rugs, brass lanterns, ceramics, spices by the kilo, vintage textiles. Bring an empty suitcase if you want to take advantage of it.

Meals: Breakfast, lunch, dinner | **Wear:** Shoulders and knees covered for the souk, shoes you can walk in all day

Day 3

SUN, MARCH 28

Balloons + the YSL gardens

- Pickup before sunrise for the hot air balloon
- Sunrise flight over the Marrakech countryside
- Back to the riad to reset
- Lunch
- Jardin Majorelle, the YSL gardens
- Dinner out together in the medina

An early one, and worth it. We will take a hot air balloon ride with sweeping views of the city and the Atlas Mountains. After a quick rest, we head to the YSL Gardens, and dinner out all together.

Meals: Breakfast, lunch, dinner | **Wear:** Warm layers for the balloon (it's cold before sunrise), something easy for the gardens

Day 4

MON, MARCH 29

Into the desert

- Breakfast + check out of the riad
- Drive out to BE Agafay
- Pool time and big views
- Sunset apéro on the hill
- Dinner at camp

We head out to the Agafay, which is a stone desert in the Atlas Mountains. We will have a toast at sunset, followed by a beautiful dinner. Yes, there's even a pool and a spa in the desert.

Meals: Brunch, dinner | **Wear:** Swimsuit for the pool, a warm layer for sunset

Day 5

TUE, MARCH 30

Quads + pottery

- Breakfast
- Quad bikes through the Agafay desert
- Pottery workshop with a local ceramic artist
- Dinner at camp

We wake up to total stillness. Eat breakfast, then we hop on ATVs and drive through the dunes. In the afternoon we do a pottery workshop, followed by sunset dinner. Then a fire under more stars than you can count.

Meals: Breakfast, dinner | **Wear:** Closed shoes, sunglasses and a scarf for the quads, whatever you like for dinner

Day 6

WED, MARCH 31

Goodbye (for now)

- Breakfast at camp, one last look at the desert
- Check out by 11:30am
- Your car back to RAK, about 45 minutes

Meals: Breakfast

Keeping you up to date. We're always looking for ways to make the week better. If anything changes on the ground, we'll share it in the group message, our main way of communicating during the retreat.

04

What's included (and what isn't)

The short version: once you land at RAK, the week is essentially handled. Here's exactly what that means.

INCLUDED

- Accommodation: 3 nights at Riad BE Marrakech + 2 nights at BE Agafay, in a shared room
- All meals: breakfast, lunch and dinner in Marrakech, brunch and dinner in the desert
- Welcome drinks, rooftop drinks and sunset cocktails in the desert
- Sunrise hot air balloon ride
- Souk trip and Jardin Majorelle (YSL gardens) visit
- Quad bike tour
- Pottery workshop
- All excursions and transfers, including a private car to and from the airport
- Pre-trip mentorship session with Sarah
- Website + brand strategy audit with Carrigan
- Pre-trip support (flights, packing, any question) and on-the-ground support all week
- Daily housekeeping

NOT INCLUDED

- Flights and any travel to Marrakech
- Travel insurance (recommended, not required, see section 7)
- Hotel nights before or after the retreat
- Extra drinks beyond what's listed
- Optional spa treatments, including the hammam
- Shopping, souvenirs and personal spending
- Tips for venue staff and local guides (see section 9)
- Local tourist tax, paid on site

05

Where you'll stay

RIAD BE MARRAKECH | 3 NIGHTS

A boutique riad in the old medina, close to the souks and Jemaa el-Fnaa. Two connected riads, a hammam and spa, an indoor yoga studio and a rooftop terrace with views over the medina rooftops. Step in from the alley and it goes quiet.

- **Address:** 23 Derb Sidi Lahcen Ou Ali, Bab Doukkala, 40030 Marrakech
- **Check-in:** from 2pm on Friday, March 26 | **Check-out:** by 11am on Monday, March 29
- **On site:** pool, hammam + spa, rooftop terraces, yoga studio
- **In your room:** AC, private bathroom
- **Wi-Fi:** Yes | **Laundry:** Yes, for a fee

BE AGAFAY | 2 NIGHTS

A small desert camp in the Agafay stone desert, with the Atlas Mountains on the horizon. Bungalows with their own terraces, a pool looking out over the desert, a spa and yoga shala, and a sunset hill for apéro.

- **Address:** Douar Lmilh Laaroussine, Agafay 40272
- **Check-in:** on arrival, Monday, March 29 | **Check-out:** by 11:30am on Wednesday, March 31
- **On site:** pool, Ritual Spa + Yoga Shala, The Hideaway restaurant, sunset hill
- **In your bungalow:** twin beds, private bathroom, AC + heating, hair dryer, toiletries, bathrobes, tea + coffee, fridge, terrace
- **Wi-Fi:** Yes

ROOMS + ROOMMATES

- Everyone shares a room, at both venues. Two guests per room, twin beds, private bathroom. You'll have the same roommate all week.
- Coming with a friend? Tell us and we'll room you together.

- Coming on your own? Name a preferred roommate, or we'll pair you based on your **Roommate Matching Quiz**.
- Room assignments go out before the retreat.

06

Getting there + getting home

You book your own flights, so you can come from anywhere and add travel on either side. Booking your own doesn't mean you're on your own. Send us any flight before you book if you want our eyes on it.

THE ONLY TWO TIMES YOU NEED

Arrive

Land at Marrakesh Menara Airport (RAK)

whenever works for you on Friday, March 26

. Our first group get-together is at 5pm.

Depart

Book the

latest flight possible on Wednesday, March 31

. It's about 45 minutes from the desert to the airport.

How you get there is up to you. Many people add a few days on the front or back end. Want help planning that part? Tell us.

Transfers: All handled by BE Agafay. Everyone has a personal car, from RAK to the riad on arrival day, from the riad to the desert on Day 4, and from the desert back to RAK on departure day. If a few of you land around the same time we'll group you together, but there's no transfer window. The airport is only about 4 km / 2.5 miles from the riad.

Arriving early or staying on? No problem. Let us know and we'll help you arrange your own transportation.

ROUTE OPTIONS

Most people connect through Europe (Paris, Madrid, Lisbon, London) or fly overnight from New York to Casablanca and connect to Marrakech. Plenty of carriers fly into Marrakech from Europe.

OUR FLIGHT ADVICE

- **Look at flights first.** Find prices and times that work for you.
- **Book in the sweet spot.** For Morocco that's usually 3 to 6 months out, so October to December for this trip. Booking much earlier rarely saves money, and fares tend to climb in the last couple of months.

- **Check them against the key times above.** Send your flights to us before you book if you're unsure.
- **Once booked, fill out the Flight + Info Form.** It also collects dietary needs, health notes and emergency contact. This is how we plan your car.

RUNNING LATE OR STUCK?

Email us at **habitat@habitatretreats.com** as soon as you know. On travel day you can also text or WhatsApp Carrigan (+1 903 515 0061). We'll rework your car. If you can't reach us, call Riad BE Marrakech at +212 524 38 45 11.

EXTENDING YOUR TRIP?

If you're adding days before or after the retreat and want recommendations, or you're curious whether we have hotel picks for Marrakech, send us a message.

07

Payments, cancellations + insurance

DEPOSIT + BALANCE

Your $500 deposit is paid and your spot is held. Your full balance is due by Wednesday, February 24, 2027 (30 days before the retreat), following the payment plan you chose at checkout. Payments come out automatically on the card saved at checkout and show on your statement as HABITAT RETREATS.

Questions about your payments? Email **habitat@habitatretreats.com**.

IF YOU NEED TO CANCEL

Life happens. Here's how it works (full details in our **Terms + Conditions**):

IF YOU CANCEL	WHAT HAPPENS
On or before Friday, November 6, 2026 (140+ days before)	Your payments (not your deposit) can be refunded, or moved to another Habitat retreat within 12 months
Saturday, November 7 to Friday, December 25, 2026 (139 to 91 days before)	50% of the retreat total (not counting your deposit) is due and non-refundable. If you've paid less than that, the difference is charged at this time
Saturday, December 26, 2026 or later (90 days or less)	No refunds. 100% of the retreat total is due at this time

- Your deposit is non-refundable and non-transferable in every case. When someone signs up, we immediately pay vendors to secure their spot, and we can't get that money back. If you cancel and part of your balance is kept under this policy, you can transfer that amount to a friend who takes your spot.
- The card you booked with is saved on file, and any amount due under this policy is charged to it.
- Cancel in writing to **habitat@habitatretreats.com**.
- No refunds if you're denied entry or don't meet passport, visa or entry requirements.
- No refunds for arriving late, leaving early, or skipping activities.
- Weather, illness and flight problems don't change the policy. That's what travel insurance is for. We wish we could accommodate everything life throws at us, but with the nature of group travel it's impossible.

TRAVEL INSURANCE

It covers the things we can't: missed flights, lost bags, medical bills abroad, and cancelling for illness or emergencies.

- Look for: trip cancellation + interruption, medical + evacuation, baggage delay.
- Traveling with expensive camera gear? Check that your policy (or your business insurance) covers it abroad.
- Buy it soon after booking. Many policies only cover pre-existing conditions if you buy within 14 to 21 days of your first payment.
- Check your credit card first. Some premium cards already include coverage.
- We've used **BattleFace** in the past and liked it. Not sure what you need? Compare your policy, your credit card's coverage and your health plan against your trip dates.

08

Passports, health + safety

PASSPORT + ENTRY

- Your passport must be valid until at least **September 30, 2027**, with at least 1 blank page. Check it today.
- US citizens: no visa needed for stays under 90 days.
- Entry is simple: show your passport at the airport and it gets stamped. Make sure it actually gets stamped, or leaving can be a hassle.
- No drones. They may be confiscated at the airport.
- Renewing your passport before the trip? Send us the new details.
- Save a photo of your passport to your phone, just in case.

HEALTH

- Vaccines: none required. The CDC recommends being up to date on routine vaccines, plus hepatitis A and typhoid for most travelers. Check the **CDC travel page for Morocco** and talk to your doctor 4 to 6 weeks before.
- Tell us about allergies, injuries, pregnancy, or health conditions in your **Flight + Info Form**. It stays between us and the people who need to know (the kitchen, your leaders). Please be thorough. The more we know, the better we can look after you.
- Bring any prescriptions in original packaging with a copy of the prescription, plus a few extra days' supply just in case.
- Pharmacies (look for the green cross) are everywhere in Marrakech.
- Drink bottled water. Skip ice and raw salads from street stalls for the first few days.
- The Moroccan sun is strong, even in March. SPF, hat and water.

SAFETY

Marrakech is a busy, welcoming city and very used to visitors. Normal travel sense applies.

- Keep your passport in the room safe.
- Pickpockets work the souks and Jemaa el-Fnaa. Keep your phone and camera close, bag zipped and in front.
- Share your location with a friend at home on travel days.

- Emergency numbers in Morocco: police 19 (190 from a mobile), ambulance 15 (150 from a mobile). We'll also be with you all week.

09

Know before you go: Morocco

WEATHER

Late March is one of the best times to be in Marrakech. Warm, sunny afternoons, cool evenings, the occasional shower. The desert is warm by the pool and properly cold after dark.

	DAY	NIGHT	RAIN
Marrakech, late March	22°C / 72°F	10°C / 50°F	A few days a month
Agafay desert	Similar	Colder than the city	Rare

MONEY

- Currency: Moroccan dirham (MAD). Roughly 9.3 MAD = $1 USD, subject to change.
- Get dirhams one of two ways: order them from your bank before you leave (call first, not every branch carries them), or use an ATM at the airport when you land. ATM stops during the week won't be scheduled, so arrive with some cash.
- Cards are fine at the riad, the camp and nicer restaurants. Souks, taxis and small shops are mostly cash.
- Bring or withdraw enough cash for souk shopping, extra drinks and tips.
- Use bank ATMs, and always choose to be charged in local currency.
- Tell your bank you're traveling.

TIPPING

Tipping is completely up to you and your experience. It's never required, but it's appreciated by the locals who make the week happen. Had an incredible experience? Tip more. Felt more "meh"? That's OK too.

- **Guides and activities:** tip them directly at the end of the activity, if you'd like.
- **Restaurants on your own:** about 10% is normal. Small tips (10 to 20 MAD) for porters and help along the way are customary.

Cash in dirhams is easiest for tips.

PHONE + DATA

- Check your carrier's international plan before you go.
- An eSIM is usually cheapest. Airalo or Holafly work well. Install before you fly, turn on when you land.
- Download offline Google Maps of the medina. Street signs are scarce.
- Our group message is how we'll all talk. Wi-Fi is available at the riad and the camp.

PLUGS + POWER

Type C and E plugs (European style), 220V. Bring 1 to 2 adapters. Most phone, laptop and camera battery chargers are fine. Hair tools often aren't, so bring dual-voltage or use the venue's.

LOCAL CUSTOMS

- Dress with shoulders and knees covered in the medina. At the riad and the camp, wear what you like.
- Non-Muslims can't enter most mosques, including the Koutoubia.
- Haggling is normal and expected in the souks.
- If you photograph locals, they may expect to be paid.
- A few words go a long way: Hello = *Salam* | Thank you = *Shukran*

What to expect on retreat

YOUR HOSTS

Sarah Lord

Wedding photographer, Sarah Lord Photo

A Texan living in Washington state. She's had a camera in her hands since 2008 and has been photographing weddings since 2016. She loves traveling as a photographer, and she built this week for the photographers who never get a weekend off.

Carrigan Whiteley

Co-founder, Habitat Retreats

Not a wedding photographer. She's been planning group trips around the world since 2019 and handles every detail before the trip and on the ground, so you don't have to think about any of it.

THE ACTIVITIES

- **Souk visit:** a morning in the souks together on Day 2, then free time to keep shopping. Shoulders and knees covered.
- **Jardin Majorelle (YSL gardens):** an afternoon visit on Day 3, after the balloon and a quick rest.
- **Hot air balloon:** sunrise flight, pickup before dawn. Flights depend on the weather. If it's grounded, we have a plan B.
- **Quad bikes:** about an hour across the desert. No experience needed. Closed shoes, sunglasses and a scarf for dust.
- **Pottery:** a hands-on workshop at the camp. No experience needed.
- Injured, pregnant, or recovering? Tell us in your **Flight + Info Form** so we can plan around it.

MENTORSHIP + BRAND AUDIT

Your pre-trip mentorship session with Sarah and website + brand strategy audit with Carrigan happen before the retreat, not during it. If you'd like either one, reach out to Sarah or Carrigan to schedule it.

FOOD

- All meals are included. In Marrakech, breakfast is at the riad, and lunch and dinner are mostly out in the city. In the desert, it's brunch and dinner at camp.

- Vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free and allergies are all covered. List them in your Flight + Info Form and the kitchen will know your name and your needs.
- Snacks or extra meals: order anytime, charged to your room. Don't forget to close your tab before departing.
- Drinks: welcome drinks, rooftop drinks and sunset cocktails are on us. Anything extra goes on your own tab. Not every restaurant in the medina serves alcohol.

FREE TIME

There's real free time built in. Hammam, rooftop, nap, wander the souks, or join whatever little crew forms that day. We'll give you ideas if you're coming up blank.

STAYING IN TOUCH

- **Email** is the best way to reach us about anything before the retreat starts, plus payments, forms and this guide.
- **Group message** is our main way of communicating during the week and shortly before. It's where we post daily updates.
- **Travel-day group chats** go out about a week before, grouped by arrival time, so you can find each other at the airport.
- **Pre-retreat group call** happens about a month before (30 min, notes sent after if you can't make it). Meet the group and ask anything. Date and time sent closer to it.

ANONYMOUS FEEDBACK

We want your week to be the best one. We also know it's hard to tell the hosts something isn't working. So during the retreat, an anonymous form stays open and we check it every day. Wishing there was more of something? Someone making you uncomfortable? Room issue? Tell us early so we can fix it before you go home. **Anonymous Feedback Form**

ARRIVAL + CHECK-OUT DAY

- **Arriving early?** If your room isn't ready, the riad will store your bags and you can head up to the rooftop.
- **Moving day (Day 4):** we'll load up together after breakfast for the drive to Agafay.
- **Check-out day:** bungalows are out by 11:30am. The camp will hold your bags until your car, and you're welcome to hang by the pool until then.

IF YOU GET SICK OR HURT

Tell us right away, day or night. We want to support you and will do whatever we can to help.

VALUABLES

Keep your passport, cards and cash in the room safe. Habitat isn't responsible for lost or damaged belongings, including camera gear, so bring nothing you'd be heartbroken to lose (or keep good track of it).

PHOTOS + EXTRAS

- **Photos:** lots of photos get taken by everyone during the week. We'll set up a group photo album and send the details during the retreat.
- **Laundry:** available at the riad, charged to your room.
- **Room tab:** extras go on your room bill. Settle it at check-out before departing, at both venues.

AFTER THE RETREAT

- **Feedback survey:** you'll get a short, fully anonymous survey after the trip. We rely on it heavily to make every retreat better, so please be honest.
- **Left something behind?** Contact the venue directly and we'll help where we can.

A FEW HOUSE RULES

- Be on time for transfers and excursions.
- Look out for each other.
- What's shared in circle stays in circle.
- Anything you book on your own during free time (extra tours, activities) isn't run by Habitat and is at your own risk.
- Your liability waiver is attached to the email with this guide. Fill it out, sign it and email it back to **habitat@habitatretreats.com** before you arrive. You can't take part without it.

11

Packing list

Luggage: completely up to you how much you bring. This is your vacation! If you have tight connections or multiple separate bookings, be mindful of checked baggage. Bags get wheeled through the medina on a cart, so a sturdy suitcase or duffel beats anything fragile. Put your name and number on everything in case it gets lost, and leave room for what you'll buy in the souks.

> **Pack a carry-on like your checked bag might be late.** If you're checking a bag, pack a swimsuit, a change of clothes, a warm layer, meds, chargers and toiletries for 2 days, just in case. Keep camera bodies and lenses in your carry-on.

TRAVEL ESSENTIALS

- [ ] Passport (valid until September 30, 2027)
- [ ] Phone, charger, power bank
- [ ] Plug adapters (1 to 2, type C/E)
- [ ] Credit/debit cards
- [ ] Travel insurance details, return flight and venue addresses saved offline
- [ ] Prescription meds in original packaging
- [ ] Headphones, eye mask, earplugs (the call to prayer starts early)
- [ ] Reusable water bottle

EVENINGS

- [ ] Dinner outfits. Whatever you want to wear on vacation, this is your week.
- [ ] Sweater or puffer for the balloon and desert nights

DAYS + EXCURSIONS

- [ ] Light clothes that cover shoulders and knees for the medina
- [ ] Swimsuit(s) + cover-up for the pool and hammam
- [ ] Comfortable walking shoes + sandals
- [ ] Closed shoes for quad bikes
- [ ] Hat + sunglasses
- [ ] Sunscreen (SPF 30+)
- [ ] Scarf (dust on the quads, sun, covering up)
- [ ] Tote or day bag

TOILETRIES + HEALTH

- [ ] Toiletries
- [ ] Basic meds: pain reliever, antihistamine, stomach settler, blister plasters
- [ ] Period products

LEAVE AT HOME

- Drones
- Hair tools that aren't dual-voltage
- Anything you'd be upset about losing

Your timeline + to-do list

Everything you need to do, in order.

Now

- [ ] Check your passport is valid until September 30, 2027
- [ ] Sign + email back your liability waiver (attached to the email with this guide)
- [ ] Buy travel insurance, and note your cancellation dates (section 7)
- [ ] Save "Morocco Wedding Photographers Retreat" in your calendar, March 26 to 31, 2027
- [ ] Coming on your own? Take the **Roommate Matching Quiz**
- [ ] Want your mentorship session or brand audit? Reach out to Sarah or Carrigan to schedule it

October to November

- [ ] Send us any flights you're considering if you want our eyes on them
- [ ] Start looking at flights. The best fares for Morocco are usually 3 to 6 months out, so October to December. Check them against the arrive and depart times in section 6
- [ ] Found a good fare? Book it. No need to wait for December

December

- [ ] Book flights by December 31 if you haven't yet (send them to us first if unsure). Fares tend to climb from January
- [ ] Fill out the **Flight + Info Form**: flights, dietary needs, health notes, emergency contact
- [ ] Book pre/post hotel nights
- [ ] Talk to your doctor about vaccines and any controlled meds

1 month out

LATE FEBRUARY

- [ ] Make sure your liability waiver is signed and returned
- [ ] RSVP to the group call
- [ ] Balance fully paid by February 24, 2027 (automatic on your plan)
- [ ] Order adapters and an eSIM

1 week out

- [ ] Look for your travel-day group chat
- [ ] Check in for flights, download boarding passes
- [ ] Download offline maps of Marrakech and your eSIM
- [ ] Pack (see section 11)

Travel day

- [ ] Passport, phone, charger, cards
- [ ] Message the group when you land

13

FAQ

The questions we get most. Still wondering something? Ask us.

BEFORE YOU GO

I'm coming alone. Will that be weird?
Not even a little. Most people do.

Is this only for wedding photographers?
Yes.

Can I bring a friend?
Absolutely, if they're a wedding photographer too! Tell them to apply the same way you did, and if they're in, we'll room you together.

How old are people who come?
Mostly 20s and 30s. The common thread is curiosity, not age.

What's the pace like?
Full but unhurried. One big thing a day, long dinners, real free time. Three nights of city energy, then two slow days in the desert.

TRAVEL

What airport should I fly into?
Marrakesh Menara Airport (RAK).

Do you book flights for me?
No, but we'll help you pick them. Send us options any time.

What if my flight is delayed?
Email us right away. On travel day, text or WhatsApp Carrigan. We'll help as best we can.

Can I arrive a day late or leave early?
You can, but we don't refund missed nights. Tell us in advance so we can plan your car.

Can I bring my drone?
No. Drones are banned in Morocco and customs will confiscate them.

Is it safe?
Marrakech is busy and very used to visitors, and you'll be with the group and local drivers for every transfer and activity. Normal city sense applies: watch your bag in the souks and ignore unofficial "guides." Habitat has been running retreats in Morocco since 2026.

ON RETREAT

Do I have to do everything?
No. Every activity is optional.

Do I need experience for the quads, the balloon or pottery?
No. Show up and we'll handle the rest.

What if the balloon can't fly?
It's weather-dependent. If it's grounded, we have a plan B.

How much free time is there?
There are two full days, then every other day has some downtime built in. Take it all at your own pace, and chill when you need to.

I have a food allergy. Will I be OK?
Yes. Put it in your Flight + Info Form. The kitchen will know your name and your allergy. Tell us or your server if anything looks off.

Is alcohol included?
Welcome drinks, rooftop drinks and sunset cocktails, yes. Anything extra is on you.

Can I get a hammam or massage?
Yes. Both venues have spas. They're optional and not included. Book through us or the front desk, charged to your room.

Will you help me before the trip?
Yes. Flight suggestions, packing, entry info, your mentorship session with Sarah and the group chat. Ask us anything.

Will there be laundry?
Yes, at the riad in Marrakech, charged to your room.

What should I wear to dinner?
Whatever you'd wear on vacation. Nothing formal. Bring a warm layer for desert nights.

What if I don't click with my roommate?
Tell us, privately or through the anonymous form. We'll help however we can.

MONEY

Do I need cash?

Yes, for the souks, extra drinks and tips. Order dirhams from your bank ahead of time or withdraw at the airport.

Should I tip?

See Tipping in section 9.

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Contacts + emergencies

Screenshot this one.

WHO	HOW TO REACH	WHEN
Habitat	habitat@habitatretreats.com	All logistics, anytime. The best way to reach us
Carrigan	+1 903 515 0061 (call, text, WhatsApp)	Anytime before the retreat, travel day + on the ground
Riad BE Marrakech	+212 524 38 45 11 beincontact@be-marrakech.com	If you can't reach us
BE Agafay	+212 6 61 73 06 65 beincontact@be-agafay.com	If you can't reach us
Local emergency	Police 19 (190 from mobile) Ambulance 15 (150 from mobile)	Police, ambulance, fire
US Embassy Rabat	+212 537 63 72 00	Lost passport, serious trouble

RIAD ADDRESS

Riad BE Marrakech, 23 Derb Sidi Lahcen Ou Ali, Bab Doukkala, 40030 Marrakech

CAMP ADDRESS

BE Agafay, Douar Lmilh Laaroussine, Agafay 40272

We can't wait to see you in Morocco.